

Land & zoning baseline

What this tool produces · *A consolidated, interactive spatial map detailing current land uses, vacant lots, property ownership boundaries, and statutory zoning restrictions across the project area,.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Regulation

Spatial

Economic

Preparing the workshop · *Land & zoning baseline*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Stripping away administrative illusions to reveal the raw, unvarnished truth of who owns the city and which spaces lie abandoned, waiting to be reclaimed for the public good.

Evidence we produce

A consolidated, interactive spatial map detailing current land uses, vacant lots, property ownership boundaries, and statutory zoning restrictions across the project area,.

Duration & Material

Duration · 3 to 6 weeks of data aggregation and mapping

Material · Open-source mapping data (OSM), municipal master plans, GIS software, field survey checklists

Reference case

In the EU Urban Agenda's "Compact Cities" initiative, a dedicated mapping layer was developed specifically to identify and manage under-used land. This baseline data provided municipal stakeholders with actionable guidelines to target vacant lots for effective redevelopment, combating urban sprawl and optimizing existing infrastructure.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Use × intensity × constraint matrix

Duration
3 to 6 weeks of data aggregation and mapping

Zone categories

-  **Residential**
-  **Mixed-use**
-  **Commercial**
-  **Industrial**
-  **Civic**
-  **Heritage**
-  **Open / Natural**

Zone profile

- Zone code**

- Permitted uses**

- Floor-area ratio (FAR)**

- Height limit**

- Coverage limit**

- Setbacks**

- Heritage / risk overlays**

- Affordable housing share**

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.